



Industry News

Dr Wietse Venema and CC win annual free software awards

The Free Software Foundation has announced the winners of the annual free software awards. Creative Commons was honoured with the Award for Projects of Social Benefit, and Dutch programmer and physicist, Dr Wietse Venema, was honoured with the Award for the Advancement of Free Software. FSF founder and president Richard Stallman presented the awards.



The FSF Award for Projects of Social Benefit is presented annually to a project that intentionally and significantly benefits society by applying free software, or the ideas of the free software movement.

Since its launch in 2001, Creative Commons has worked to foster a growing body of creative, educational and scientific works that can be shared and built upon by others. Creative Commons has also worked to raise awareness of the harm inflicted by increasingly restrictive copyright regimes. In receiving this award, Creative Commons joins previous winners Groklaw (2007), Sahana (2006), and Wikipedia (2005).

The Award for the Advancement of Free Software went to Wietse Venema. The awards committee honoured both Venema's significant and wide-ranging technical contributions to network security, and his creation of the Postfix e-mail server. He joins a distinguished list of previous free software award winners: Harald Welte (2007), Ted Ts'o (2006), Andrew Tridgell (2005), Theo de Raadt (2004), Alan Cox (2003), Lawrence Lessig (2002), Guido van Rossum (2001), Brian Paul (2000), Miguel de Icaza (1999), and Larry Wall (1998).

This year's award committee was composed of Suresh Ramasubramanian (chair), Peter H. Salus, Raj Mathur, Hong Feng, Andrew Tridgell, Jonas Oberg, Verner Vinge, Richard Stallman, and Fernanda G. Weiden.

SpikeSource targets ISVs in India

SpikeSource, along with its distribution partners, has announced plans to target independent software vendors (ISVs) in India with the 'SpikeSource Solutions Factory' platform. This is an end-to-end automated platform for testing, packaging, certifying and supporting software solutions of all kinds (including open source, proprietary and hybrid solutions) for global distribution.

"In India, ISVs are developing innovative solutions that have significant market potential, yet most of them are achieving only a fraction of their total market potential. The key obstacles are lack of access to global distributions, limited market awareness, customer reluctance to purchase solutions from unknown providers, and customer uncertainty about the quality of the solutions. The SpikeSource Solutions Factory platform helps remove these obstacles," said Ramesh Shastri, managing director, India, SpikeSource. "Along with our distribution partners, the SpikeSource Solutions Factory platform enables ISVs to deliver higher quality, more trustworthy solutions, reduce their development and support costs, and increase their sales and profit potential through access to global distributions."



MontaVista adopts Moblin

MontaVista Software has announced support for the Moblin software platform. By supporting Moblin and Intel Atom processors, developers of embedded devices can rely on the commercial quality and support provided by MontaVista Software to deliver new and innovative products to market, sources at the company said.

"We are excited to be part of the Moblin community. It offers compatibility with existing and future x86 development environments and tools that allow the reuse of existing, mature development infrastructure. By delivering MontaVista's embedded Linux commercialisation based on Moblin, device manufacturers can bring commercial devices to market quickly and cost effectively," said Joerg Bertholdt, VP of marketing at MontaVista Software.

"Since Moblin is optimised to deliver on what embedded customers need, MontaVista is well positioned to provide the time to market advantage for a wide range of customers across embedded market segments," said Ram Peddibhotla, open source business director, Intel Software and Services Group.

Wind River, Intel to market optimised multi-core solutions

Wind River has announced that working in conjunction with Intel, the two companies will collaborate to market optimised multi-core solutions for the embedded market by aligning research and development, sales and marketing, professional services, and engineering resources. The two companies will initially target the aerospace and defence, network infrastructure, industrial, medical and print imaging market segments.

More information about Wind River's multi-core solutions can be found at www.windriver.com/multicore-software.